

Education Indicator

PROVIDER

Pacific Parent Representation on School Boards

Proportional Pacific parent representation on school boards has remained around 40% from 2013. Secondary schools had the highest level of proportional Pacific parent representation on school boards.

Indicator Description

The percentage of schools with proportional Pacific parent representation on the school board as at 1 December.

Why this is important

Active participation by Pacific parents in planning, development and delivery of education services will help to ensure that those services are appropriate and effective for Pacific students. Pacific parent representation on school boards is one key mechanism for participation.

The Government is committed to strengthening schools/kura boards by providing support and encouraging them to be more representative of the communities they serve. The Ministry is now making progress around board capability, including work to make boards more representative of their communities.

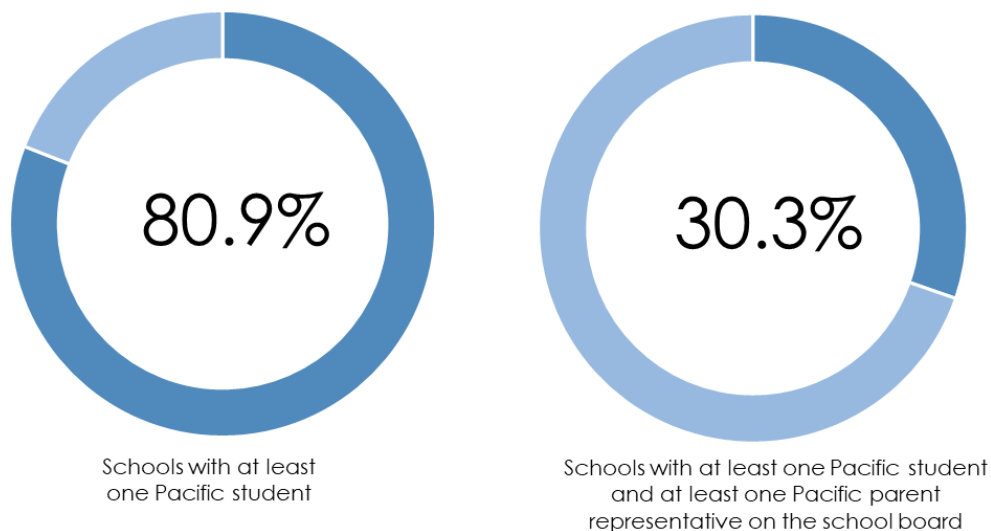
School boards comprise the principal, parent representatives, a staff representative and may also include other members. Boards of state and state-integrated schools must hold elections for parent representatives every three years. A board may also decide to adopt a mid-term election cycle where half of its parent representatives are elected at a mid-term election (18 months after the triennial election) and the remainder are elected at the triennial election.

Triennial elections have been held every three years since 1998 with the most recent elections in 2022. A by-election can occur at any stage in the election cycle if an elected parent representative leaves the board and creates a vacancy. Although the major changes in board membership occur in triennial election years, there is still some fluctuation in intervening years due to by-elections and mid-term elections.

How are we going

In 2022, 80.9% of the schools¹ (1,931 schools) had at least one Pacific student (Figure 1). Of the schools with Pacific students, 30.3% had at least one Pacific parent representative on the school board.

Figure 1: In 2022, around one-third of the schools with at least one Pacific student had at least one Pacific parent representative on the school board



Proportional Representation

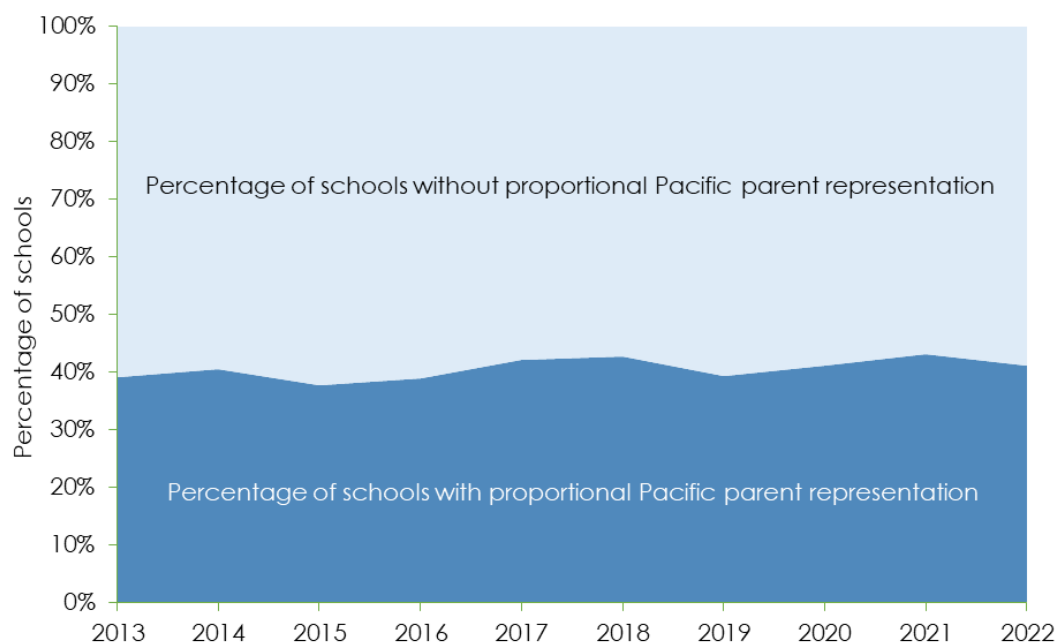
In 2022, there were 701 schools (29.4%) with enough Pacific students to expect at least one Pacific parent representative on the school board. This is based both on the number of Pacific students in a school and the number of positions on the board.

Representation on a school board is “proportional” when the proportion of board seats held by Pacific parents is at least equivalent to the proportion of Pacific students in the school. This is restricted to those schools with enough Pacific students to expect at least one Pacific parent representative on the board.

The percentage of schools with proportional Pacific parent representation on the school board is 41.1% in 2022. The proportional Pacific parent representation on school boards has stayed around 40% from 2013 (Figure 2).

¹ Schools with available parent school board information.

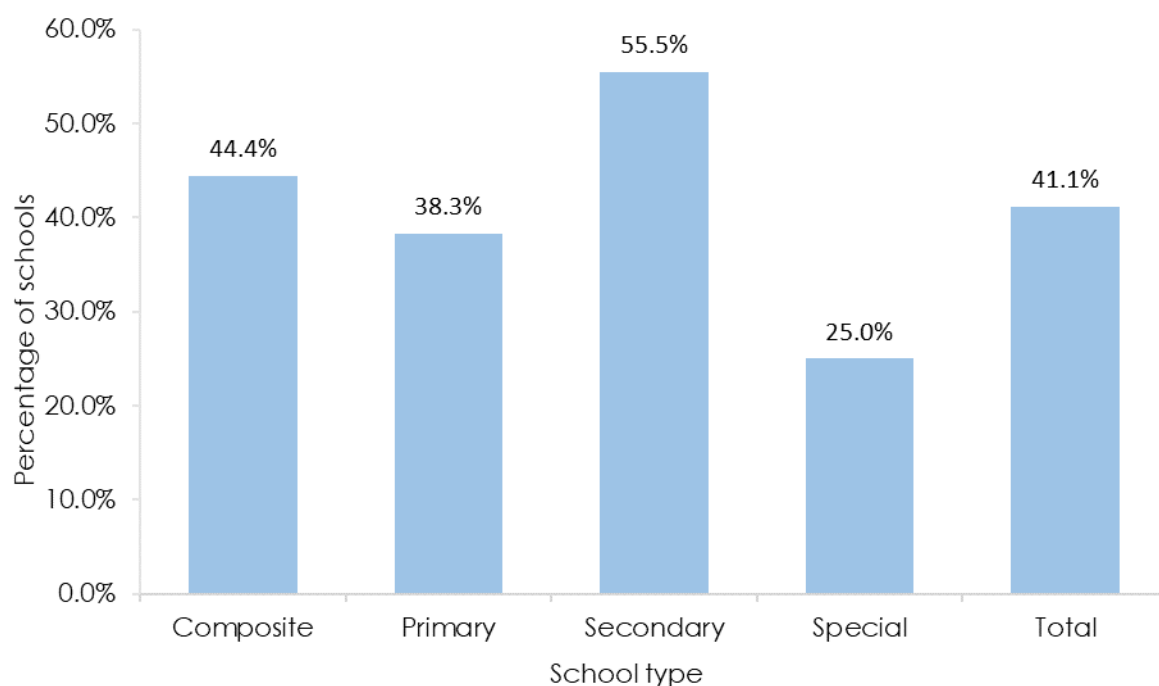
Figure 2: The percentage of schools with proportional Pacific parent representation has remained around 40% from 2013



School Type

In 2022, secondary schools had the highest proportional Pacific parent representation on the board (55.5%) followed by composite schools (44.4%). The lowest Pacific parent representation was in special schools (25.0%) (Figure 3).

Figure 3: Secondary schools had the highest Pacific parent representation in 2022



Where to Find Out More

To obtain further information about school boards try:

- [School boards statistics](#)
- [Māori parent representation on school boards](#)

References

- [Education and Training Act 2020](#)
- [Your school board – Parents.education.govt.nz – Practical information about education for parents and carers](#)

